been some sort of quarrel between Nuyān Kūkūldāsh and him which lasted till the end.

On the other hand, when Babur heard of Aūzbegs' retiring, he sent a man to Khān and marched from Bīsh-kīnt with the purpose to spend a couple of days amongst the villages in the Blacksmith's-dale. Mullā Ḥaidar's son, Mūmin invited Nuyān Kūkūldāsh, Aḥmad-i-Qāsim, and some others in the name of returning them the hospitality received in Samarkand. Hence when Babur left for Bīsh-kīnt, they chose to stay back. Mūmin hosted this treat on the edge of a canyon.

The next day, the news about Nuyān reached Babur while he was stationed in Sām-sīrak, a village in the blacksmith's-dale. He had fallen into the ravine in an inebriated state and had succumbed to his injuries. Babur sent a search party headed by his own mother's brother, Ḥaq-nazar, to find the body from where he had fallen. His body was found at the bottom of the ravine and was buried with the rituals in the earth in Bīsh-kīnt. Many, including Babur, suspected that it was indeed Mūmin, who, blinded by petty rancour, committed the crime against Nuyān. But the truth never came out.

Babur was broken by this incident. He had not felt such grief, except after the unfortunate death of his father. He kept weeping perpetually for ten days.

Now, summer had begun to approach; and with this pleasing moment came a piece of pale news that Shaybāni Khān was coming to Aūrā-tīpā. Thereby without wasting any time, Babur along with his men crossed the Āb-burdan pass into the Macha hill country. Āb-burdan was the last village of Macha. Just below it, a spring sent its water down to the river, Zarafshan. A tomb existed at the springhead. At the edge of the springhead, Babur inscribed three couplets on a rock after having got it shaped:[*]

> I have heard that Jamshīd, the magnificent,
> Inscribed on a rock at a fountain-head
> 'Many men like us have taken a breath at this fountain,
> And have passed away in the twinkling of an eye;
> We took the world by courage and might,
> But we took it not with us to the tomb.

It was a regular tradition to inscribe verses on the rocks in the country of hills. While they were in Macha, an acclaimed poet Mullā Hijrī came from